



National Trust *for*
Historic Preservation®

June 13, 2023

\$3.8M in Action Fund Grants Help Protect 40 African American Historic Sites

More :

[African American Cultural Heritage Action Fund](#)

By :

National Trust for Historic Preservation

Grants from the African American Cultural Heritage Action Fund advance ongoing preservation activities for historic places such as homes, museums, and landscapes that represent African American cultural heritage. To date, the program has supported 242 historic African American places and invested more than \$20 million to help preserve significant sites imbued with Black life, humanity, and cultural heritage.

With amounts ranging from \$50,000 to \$155,000, these Action Fund grants support preservation work in four primary areas: Capital Projects,

Community Development Projects, Historic Preservation Projects, and Preservation Projects.

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ACCEPT ALL

NECESSARY ONLY

- [HBCU Cultural Heritage Stewardship Initiative](#) [Link: #hbcus]

National Grant Program



Black Heritage
Trail of New
Hampshire, Inc.

Black Heritage Trail of New Hampshire

Black Heritage Trail of
New Hampshire, Inc. |
Portsmouth, New
Hampshire

Augmented reality will
guide visitors to markers
along the Black Heritage
Trail of New Hampshire to
view 3D representations of
the people and places
featured, bringing the area's
history to life. This engaging
experience will be a

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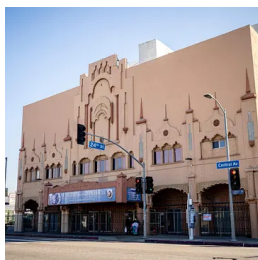
Brown Studio
Architects

Freedom Quilting Bee Manufacturing Building

Freedom Quilting Bee
Legacy | Alberta,
Alabama

The Freedom Quilting Bee Cooperative was established in Alberta, Alabama, by Civil Rights activists Francis X. Walter and Estelle Witherspoon in 1966. This space now serves as a museum showcasing this community's artistic legacy and providing educational programming. A project planning grant will

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Jennifer Tarango

Lincoln Theatre

Coalition for
Responsible Community
Development | Los
Angeles, California

Referred to as the "Apollo of the West," the Lincoln Theatre opened in Los Angeles in 1927 on Central Avenue, a social, cultural, and political hub for African American art, literature, and music. In December 2020, the Coalition for Responsible Community Development acquired the theater with the intention of restoring it as a space for live performances, community events and

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return this historically significant West Coast Black performance space to prominence.



Maryland State
Archives

Elktonia Beach Heritage Park

Blacks of the Chesapeake
Foundation | Annapolis,
Maryland

Swimming pools, beaches,
and other recreational
facilities were a major
national battleground
during the struggle for Black
civil rights, as segregation
prohibited Black Americans
from equal access to leisure
activities. Purchased in 1902

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enjoy leisure activities. In partnership with the City of Annapolis, Blacks of the Chesapeake Foundation will utilize this grant to develop a comprehensive plan to ensure that the interpretation of the area's Black history forms an integral part of the plans for the new Elktonia Heritage Park.



Peter Bug Shoe

Todd Jones

Academy

DC Historic Preservation
Office | Washington,
D.C.

Started in 1977 and housed
in a historic plaza, the Peter

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1968 and designed by noted landscape architect M. Paul Friedberg and Simon Breines, an architect and pedestrian rights advocate. Funding will support developing an Architectural/Engineering (AE) Study of the building.



The Cherry
Community
Organization

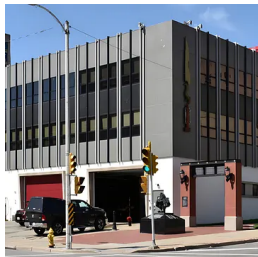
Morgan School

The Cherry Community
Organization |
Charlotte, North
Carolina

Built in 1925 and closed in
1968 due to integration,
Morgan School was

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the Morgan School, the Cherry Community Organization envisions a new life for the site as the Historic Morgan School Community Learning and Heritage Center. A business plan with a comprehensive fundraising strategy will provide these community stewards with the necessary roadmap to preserve Morgan School and ensure that its educational legacy has a sustainable future.



Paul Wellington

Sites of

Alonzo Robinson

University of Wisconsin-

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four decades, Robinson lent his distinctive Modernist aesthetic to a number of civic and commercial buildings, houses, and community churches in Milwaukee and surrounding areas. The University plans to utilize the funding for a comprehensive survey and inventory of Robinson's work that will include collaboration with Robinson's descendants and a partnership with the Wisconsin Black Historical Society.

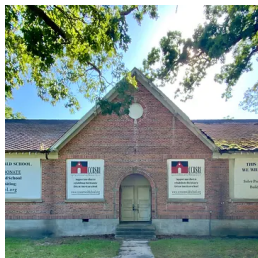


1st Neighbor

Idlewild's

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For several decades, the Black resort township of Idlewild served as the premiere recreational retreat from the urban city life for middle-class African Americans during the era of Jim Crow. The capital project grant will go towards stabilizing the Hotel Casa Blanca, thus securing the structural integrity of a historical artifact and architectural treasure and helping to anchor the economic redevelopment of Idlewild as a contemporary space for Black respite.



Cape

Cape Charles
Rosenwald School
Restoration
Initiative

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Initiative | Cape Charles, Virginia

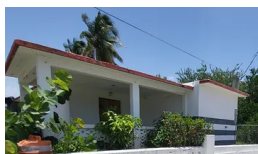
Constructed in 1929 to educate African American elementary school students in the Cape Charles community, the Cape Charles Rosenwald School is a rare example of a brick four-teacher Rosenwald School. Funding will be used to restore the building's windows, a crucial step towards the adaptive reuse of the property as an educational center and community gathering space.



Carver Birthplace
Association

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Built in 1872, the Neosho Colored School was the first school attended by Black agricultural scientist and inventor George Washington Carver. Now located close to the George Washington Carver National Monument, the school will utilize this grant to complete the interior rehabilitation and address exterior building needs guided by a Historic Structure Report. Improvements to the site will allow it to continue interpreting Carver's life and legacy and telling the story of the struggle for access to education for Black children in Reconstruction-era Missouri.



Casa

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Ancón de Loíza

Colectivo El Ancón de Loíza | Loíza, Puerto Rico

Formerly the home of the Cortijo family, Casa Cortijo serves as a community organization and gathering place dedicated to the recognition and celebration of the history of Loíza and Afro-Caribbean culture. The Cortijo family operated a rope-pulled barge that provided crossing from shore to shore of the Río Grande de Loíza, connecting the northeast of the country to the metropolitan area of the island for generations during which the community was denied a bridge. Capital repairs to select interior and exterior building features will assist in preserving this

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Scott Clark

Southgate Street School

Historic Preservation
Office of Newport |
Newport, Kentucky

Built in 1893 for African American students, the Southgate Street schoolhouse is currently a museum and education center exploring the Newport community's history. Funding will provide for updating the building's HVAC system, restoring its windows and doors, and repairing interior water damage.

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WJE Associates

Philadelphia,
Pennsylvania

Located in North Philadelphia's Strawberry Mansion neighborhood, the home of renowned 19th-century Black American painter Henry Ossawa Tanner and his accomplished family is near collapse. Known for his highly recognizable painting *The Banjo Lesson*, funding will stabilize the home and repair its roof. These critical repairs will help ensure that the Tanner family's story of achievement can be told to future generations.

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Museum
of
African
American
History
|

Marsha L. Fader

Nantucket, Massachusetts

The only public building constructed and occupied by African Americans in the 19th century still standing on Nantucket, the African American Meeting House is a prominent reminder that African and African American people once thrived on the island as part of the New Guinea community. The harsh coastal climate has deteriorated the windows and required the caretakers to focus on restoring and repairing antique glass and other necessary materials to sustain the integrity of this

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Kwendeche

Menifee Gymnasium

Town of Menifee |
Menifee, Arkansas

By 1938, a community built by formerly enslaved and freed black families in Menifee had established a school district recognized as "one of the best operating rural schools in Arkansas," resulting in its selection by the Works Progress Administration as a site for a new gymnasium. Today, the Menifee Gymnasium is one of the only remaining structures to survive a devastating tornado in

1969. The gymnasium is a

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social center for Black
residents.

YMI

YMI Cultural
Center

Cultural Center

YMI Cultural Center,
Inc. | Asheville, North
Carolina

The nation's first free-standing Black cultural center, the Young Men's Institute has been a cultural hub for Asheville's African American community since it opened in 1893.

Constructed by 100 Black builders and craftspeople, the center has long been a

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elements as well as
repainting the building's
interior.

United Order of
Tents Eastern
District #3

United Order of Tents Eastern District #3

United Order of Tents
Eastern District #3 |
Brooklyn, New York

Two formerly enslaved
women, Annetta Minkins
Lane of Norfolk, Virginia and
Harriet R. Taylor of
Hampton, Virginia, founded
the United Order of Tents in

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Eastern District #3 chapter focuses its mission on serving the local community with emphasis on outreach to elderly residents. Funding will support the restoration and preservation of the chapter's historic headquarters at 87 MacDonough Street.

L.V. Hull

Yaphet Smith

Home & Studio

Keysmith Foundation |
Kosciusko, Mississippi

Self-proclaimed "Unusual Artist" L.V. Hull transformed her home into an artistic

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structure form part of the
upcoming L.V. Hull Legacy
Center.

The

The Slave
Dwelling Project

Slave Dwelling Project

The Slave Dwelling
Project | Ladson, South
Carolina

The Slave Dwelling Project
documents and preserves
dwellings of the enslaved
and engages communities
through educational public
sleepovers, conferences,
and living history programs.

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making in the style of
enslaved craftsmen, and
blacksmith demonstrations
from expert blacksmiths.

Dew Drop Inn

Level
Ground |
New
Orleans,

Ryan Gootee
General
Contractors

Louisiana

Known as the “South’s
swankiest night spot” in the
mid-1900s, the Dew Drop
Inn is a symbol of the
enterprising spirit of Black
business. Level Ground will
create a comprehensive and
immersive exhibition to fill
the newly restored site,
which includes a boutique
hotel and music venue. The

Location of this project

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St.

St. Johns County
Cultural Council,
Inc.

Johns County African American Heritage Trail

St. Johns County
Cultural Council, Inc. |
St. Augustine, Florida

Home to a city known for its
fusion of African American,
Indigenous, and Spanish
colonial history and
representing the southern-
most point of the Gullah
Geechee National Heritage
Corridor, St. Johns County is
comprised of some of the
most historically significant

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the history of the area and
increase visitor
engagement.

The Kuzara
Collection
Wyoming Room,
Sheridan County
Fulmer Library

Sheridan County Iron Riders Historic Trail

Sheridan Community Land
Trust | Sheridan,
Wyoming

In 1897, African American
soldiers of the 25th Infantry
Regiment Bicycle Corps
rode 1,900 miles through
Wyoming and Montana to

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their epic journey through
the American West.

Josh Miller

(Un)Known Project Augmented Reality App

IDEAS xLab | Louisville,
Kentucky

As a further activation of the
“On the Banks of Freedom”
public art installation, the
(Un)Known Project
Augmented Reality App will
highlight historic sites of
enslavement around
Louisville. Funding for the

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through voiceovers, music,
and poetry.

Jill Williams

Calfee Training School

Calfee Community &
Cultural Center, Inc. |
Pulaski, Virginia

Alumni joined with partners
to preserve this 1939 school
for African American
students that was integral to
the story of education
equality. An immersive
multimedia exhibit will be
developed to tell the story
of the 1947 lawsuit, which

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Mt Zion - Female
Union Band
Historic Memorial
Park Inc.

Mount Zion Cemetery and Female Union Band Society Cemetery

Black Georgetown
Foundation | Washington,
D.C.

Listed on the National
Register of Historic Places,
these two cemeteries are
the final resting place for
8,000-10,000 African
Americans who lived and
worked in the Georgetown
area from the 1700s to the
1950s. Along with being the
oldest Black cemeteries in

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salary of a full-time Executive
Director who will help to
preserve and restore this
important piece of history.

Independence
Heights
Conservancy

Independence Heights

Independence Heights
Conservancy | Houston,
Texas

Founded at the turn of the
twentieth century,
Independence Heights is
the first incorporated
municipality created by
African Americans in Texas.
The important history and

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Independence Heights Conservancy will help the organization manage the neighborhood's cultural and historical assets, establish cultural programming, and be the key voice for the neighborhood.

Conserving Black Modernism

Conserving Black Modernism is a program to preserve Modern architecture by Black architects and designers. In its first grant round, eight historic structures are receiving \$1.2 million to help advance long-term preservation planning. This funding is part of the [Conserving Black Modernism](#) [Link: /conserving-black-modernism] partnership led by the Action Fund with support from the Getty Foundation.

Nicole Bissey

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City of Wichita |
Wichita, Kansas

Constructed in 1969, the Charles McAfee Pool House, with its distinctive modular shade structures, was designed by Black architect Charles McAfee, one of the founding members of the National Organization of Minority Architects (NOMA). Funding will go towards developing a preservation plan to guide the site's future maintenance and long-term care.

Elon Schoenholz

Watts

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A design collaboration between African American architects Robert Kennard and Arthur Silvers, the Watts Happening Cultural Center is a centerpiece for Black arts and culture in the Watts neighborhood of South Los Angeles. Funding will enable the development of a Historic Structure Report and preservation plan to guide future rehabilitation and programming for this cultural anchor, home of the historic Mafundi Institute and other community organizations.

Elon Schoenholz

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The Spanish Rancho- and Japanese-influenced Carson City Hall, with its organic, nautical-inspired forms, was designed by Black architect Robert Kennard, whose firm is the oldest Black American architectural firm in Los Angeles. A Historic Structure Report will provide information to address the preservation needs of the building and landscape as well as enhance public educational programming to raise awareness about the site's importance.

First

Tema Nicole
Stauffer

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Recognized as the oldest Black Baptist church in Charlotte, North Carolina, First Baptist Church-West was designed by Harvey Gantt, the first Black Mayor of Charlotte and the first African American student admitted to Clemson University. A comprehensive plan will allow the history of the sanctuary to be preserved with necessary repairs to the roof and baptismal area.

Tema Nicole
Stauffer

Fourth Baptist Church's

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Established in 1859, Fourth Baptist Church is one of the oldest Black congregations in Virginia. The church's modernist educational wing was designed by Ethel Bailey Furman, the earliest known Black woman architect in Virginia. Furman was self-taught and designed an estimated two hundred residences and churches in Virginia as well as two churches in Liberia. A Historic Structure Report with limited capital repairs will give the congregation the information they need to preserve the educational wing and allow future generations to learn about the trailblazing legacy of Ethel Bailey Furman.

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Morgan State University's Jenkins Hall

Morgan State University
| Baltimore, Maryland

Named after a former president of the University, Jenkins Hall was designed by Louis Edwin Fry, the first African American to receive a master's degree in architecture from Harvard. Morgan State University will complete a conservation management plan and reuse study to determine the optimal future use for the building while preserving its monumental history.

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of Detroit's Education Building

Second Baptist Church of
Detroit | Detroit,
Michigan

Second Baptist Church of Detroit is home to the oldest Black congregation in Michigan. Established in 1836, the church played a significant role in the social and political lives of generations of Black Detroit residents. Renowned Black architect Nathan Johnson designed the Modernist education building in 1968, which allowed the congregation to further its educational impact. A comprehensive building assessment with limited capital repairs will equip the congregation with the necessary framework to preserve the educational

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Zion

Tema Nicole
Stauffer

Baptist Church

Zion Baptist Church |
Philadelphia,
Pennsylvania

Renowned Black architect
Walter Livingston, Jr.
designed Zion Baptist
Church in the early 1970s.
Characterized by its
dramatic clerestory walls
composed of colorful
staggered glass panels that
rise above the brick first
story, the church embodies
a deep civil rights history,
having been led by civil
rights leader Reverend Leon
Sullivan. A comprehensive
building assessment and
preservation plan will

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HBCU Cultural Heritage Stewardship Initiative

The preservation of Historically Black Colleges & Universities (HBCUs) across the country is a key focus of this year's grant announcement. Through the Action Fund's [HBCU Cultural Heritage Stewardship Initiative](#) [Link: /hbcus] , six HBCUs are receiving nearly \$700,000 funding to ensure the protection of their cultural assets.

Morris College

Morris College

Morris College | Sumter,
South Carolina

Founded in 1908 by the
Baptist Educational
Missionary and Sunday
School Convention of South
Carolina, Morris College is
integral to the Sumter, South

© 2023 Morris College

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College spans 12 acres and includes historic buildings dating from 1924. A comprehensive planning project will include the development of a campus-wide stewardship plan to evaluate and preserve the College's buildings and strengthen the historical foundation on which it was established.

Talladega College

Talladega College

Talladega College |
Talladega, Alabama

Comprised of a 55-acre

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formally enslaved men, its historic buildings date from 1869 including the college's Savery Library, the original home of the nationally recognized Amistad murals painted by noted artist Hale Woodruff. A comprehensive project plan, which will include the college's first campus-wide preservation plan and its first master plan, will lay the foundation for the preservation of Talladega College's rich history.

Dillard
University

Dillard

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